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APPS



**Snapchat will now let
your friends know you've
made it home safe**

Snapchat is launching a new way for users to let their friends and family know they've made it home safe after an outing, called "Home Safe," the social network announced on Thursday.

To use the feature, you need to set your home location by tapping your Bitmoji on Snap Map and then "My Home." When you head out and want to notify a friend when you get home, open the conversation, tap the Map icon, and then the Home Safe button.

Your friend will receive an automatic alert in your chat conversation once you arrive home.

IMAGE CREDITS:

KIRILL KUDRYAVTSEV/AFP / GETTY IMAGES

Snapchat notes that alerts can only be sent to friends you already share your location with. Plus, since location sharing on Snap Map is off by default, no one can see your location or receive a Home Safe alert unless you choose to share it.

"Whether you're heading back from a first date, a crowded concert, or a weekend getaway, Home Safe can offer a close friend or family member peace of mind that you've made it home safely," Snapchat wrote in a blog post.

This new feature comes two months after Snapchat [announced that Snap Map](#) now has more than 400 million monthly active users.

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Snap Map, which launched in 2017, was originally a way for users to see their friends' locations and browse public snaps from around the world. Over time, the feature has evolved and now offers ways for users to [discover local hotspots](#) and find things to do.

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

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Snap Map reaches new milestone of 400M monthly active users

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users, a new milestone for one of the app's core features.

Launched in 2017, Snap Map was originally a way for users to see their friends' locations and browse public snaps from around the world. Over time, the feature has evolved and now offers ways for users to [discover local hotspots](#) and find things to do.

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Snap Map’s success is important for Snapchat, as it’s a crucial part of the social network and gives it a competitive edge over rivals like Instagram and TikTok, both of which don’t offer real-time social discovery in the way that Snap Map does.

Instagram is aware of this, as the Meta-owned social network has been spotted working on a [“Friend Map”](#) that would allow users to see their friends’ locations in real time.

“Snap Map is one of the most used mobile maps in the world, and we’re thrilled to see our community continue to grow,” said Ceci Mourkogiannis, VP of Product at Snap, in a statement to TechCrunch. “The Snap Map is helping hundreds of millions connect with friends and their favorite places and discover what’s happening around them, making the world feel more connected every day.”

The news comes as Snapchat has been updating Snap Map with additional functionality over the years. Last year, the company launched a [“Footsteps” feature](#) that lets you see how much of the world you’ve explored and track where you’ve traveled.

Plus, Snapchat rolled out [“Promoted Places”](#) on Snap Map as a way for users to discover new places. For brands, Promoted Places offers the ability to advertise and showcase all of their locations on Snap Map.

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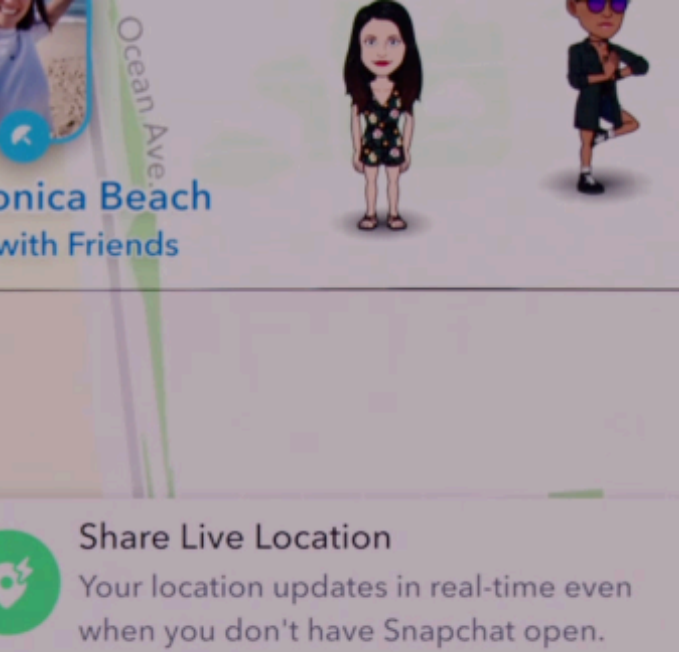
APPS



Snapchat unveils new Story modes, updates to

Snap Map, enhanced Bitmoji and more

Aisha Malik — 10:20 AM PDT · April 19, 2023



At its Snap Partner Summit today in Santa Monica, Snapchat unveiled a series of new features coming to its app. The company is rolling out new Stories features, adding updates to the Snap Map, enhancing Bitmoji, introducing new ways to virtually interact with friends and more.

Snapchat is launching two new shared Story modes, starting with “Communities,” which is a shared Story for interacting with people in the same school. With this new Story mode, users from the same school can see what other people on campus are up to, build new friendships and share their point of view. Snapchat has tested the new Story mode in certain schools, and plans to roll out Communities to additional colleges and high schools this month.

IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

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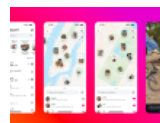
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The second new shared Story mode is called “After Dark.” You can add to an After Dark Story after 8 pm. Snapchat sees the new feature as a way to relive last night’s highlights, whether you were up late studying for finals or went to a concert. Only the friends who posted to the After Dark story have access to view the Snaps when they’re shared the following morning. Snapchat plans to add a similar shared Story for early birds in the future.

Snapchat also announced an update to Memories, its flashback feature that lets users reminisce on what they were doing on a given day exactly a year ago. The company is now launching “Friendship Flashbacks” that will surface throwbacks generated from the Snaps saved between you and a friend. The flashbacks will resurface directly in your conversations.

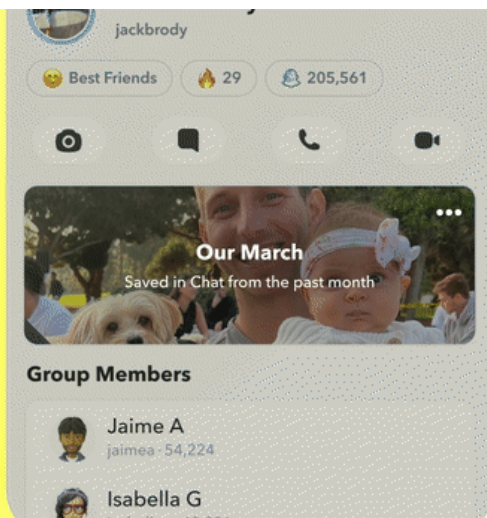


IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

As for the Snap Map, the company is introducing a new location-sharing mode called “Live Location” that updates in the background. Prior to this update, you could only share your location with a friend for a set period of time, but now you can do so indefinitely. The new feature is similar to Apple’s Find My, as it constantly shares your live location with a friend.

Snapchat is also enhancing the Snap Map and adding 3D visual elements. When you move around the new map, you’ll see local landmarks in a more

detailed way. The company says the purpose of the new map is to allow users to explore their surroundings in a new way. The new updated Map will roll out to all users in the coming months.



IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

In addition, the updated Snap Map will start suggesting places that Snap thinks users would want to check out. Snapchat is adding a new “Popular Last Night” tag to the Snap Map to let users see where their friends were recently hanging out. Jack Brody, Snap’s VP of Product, said during the event that the company found that when its most active users see places marked as “Top Picks” on the Snap Map, they’re 18% more likely to visit that place in person.

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As for AR, the company recently rolled out a Lens that lets users virtually appear together when on a video call say in a car or swimming together in the sea. To build on this, Snapchat plans to soon launch a more interactive Lens that lets users complete puzzles and play games together while they're face-to-face on a video call.

IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

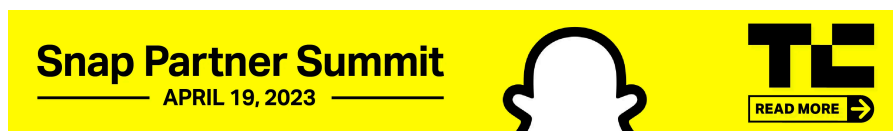
Snapchat is also introducing a new Activity Center that makes it easier for users to stay up to speed on what their friends are up to. You can swipe down from the camera to access the Activity Center and see where your friends are on the Snap Map, get notified if your friend updated their Bitmoji outfit and see if it's someone's birthday.

In terms of Bitmoji, Snapchat announced that it plans to launch an updated avatar style that features a more expressive look with realistic dimensions, shading and lighting. The company didn't reveal any further details about the updated design but said that the change would be coming "soon."

IMAGE CREDITS: SNAPCHAT

As for Bitmoji clothing, the company announced that it's bringing digital fashion from Marvel to its Bitmoji community. Users will be able to accessorize their Bitmoji with apparel inspired by characters in the Marvel Universe.

Snapchat says that nearly 1.7 billion Bitmojis have been created globally, which is a significant increase from the 1 billion figure that it shared at last year's Snap Partner Summit event.



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